

TOWARDS INQUIRY BASED AESTHETIC-ASSESSMENT OF RESONANT-WRITING FOR WOMEN IN CANCER

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Abstract

This work-in-progress paper is driven by the question: how Resonant-Writing (RW) can be designed and aesthetically assessed to approach alienation phenomena in social-spaces to support German and migrant women in cancer? The question is emerged in a design-project by a community of volunteer coworkers interested in supporting German and migrant women in cancer. The migrant-women have been migrated to Germany due to wars or repressive conditions in their home-countries (e.g., Ukraine, Turkey or Syria). The paper presents the challenging issues of RW aesthetic-assessment that face the community coworkers during three practices to enable aesthetic-Illustration driven writing, namely:

- a) writing practice by theatre assisted social-workers,
- b) writing practice by art-therapy workers, and
- c) writing practice by platform-development workers to serve the community's online-platform.

To approach the community's challenges, the paper suggests an innovative design-approach towards inquiry based RW aesthetic-assessment. The paper shows how the design-approach is conceptualized to enable researching how to integrate the design theorist Christopher Alexander's views on "inner beauty & living-structures" and the sociologist Hartmut Rosa's theory of "resonance" to approach alienation phenomena in social-spaces. The alienation phenomena under study in scope of this paper are limited to alienation phenomena that face German and migrant women in cancer. The paper also shows how the suggested design-approach can enable a space for RW aesthetic-assessment in the three practices of aesthetic-Illustration driven writing. The suggested space enables also researching the community self-assessment methods for improving the holistic-quality of their aesthetic-Illustration driven writings. To put the suggested design-approach in action, design test-cases are presented as next steps of this work-in-progress paper. Finally, the paper summarizes the limits of the design-approach and our future work to improve it.

Keywords: Aesthetic-Assessment, Resonant-Writing, Rosa's theory of "resonance", Women in Cancer, Alexander's Views on Inner beauty and Living Structures.

1 INTRODUCTION

This paper reports about a design-project managed by a community of volunteer coworkers interested in supporting German and migrant-women in cancer. The project helps volunteer coworkers reflects on how to understand and approach the alienation phenomena experienced and reported by women in cancer. It provides also inclusive social-space for German women and migrant-women to share their experiences in approaching the alienation feelings. The project's volunteers are organized in three common interest groups, namely:

- Group-AT: it is a group of volunteers interested in **Art Therapy** (AT) co-working
- Group-SD: it is a group of volunteers interested **Software Development** (SD) co-working for community platform.
- Group-TAS: it is a group of volunteers interested in **Theatre Assisted Socialization** (TAS) co-working for nursing care.

To reduce the complexity of their co-working and to improve its quality, the three groups of co-workers have reflected on how to capture and maintain their co-working quality. As outcome of their reflection on how to design aesthetic assessments to measure quality of their draft co-working scripts, a research question has been emerged. The question is:

- 1 how **Resonant-Writing** (*RW*) can be designed and aesthetically assessed to approach alienation phenomena in social-spaces to support German and migrant women in cancer?

To answer this question, the project research workshops and goals should be clearly defined. In next section the project research workshops are presented in big picture

2 PROJECT RESEARCH WORKSHOPS

Fig. 1 shows in big picture how the workshops are organized as coworking spaces to research and experiment *RW*. It shows also a simple workflow to exchange the draft scripts between the three groups of co-workers. The *AT* co-workers produce illustrations driven scripts that can be used and enhanced by the *SD* co-workers to produce programmable scripts. The programmable scripts can be used and enhanced by the *TAS* co-workers to produce theatre scripts. The theatre scripts can be used and enhanced by the *AT* co-workers for their advanced writing script inquiries.

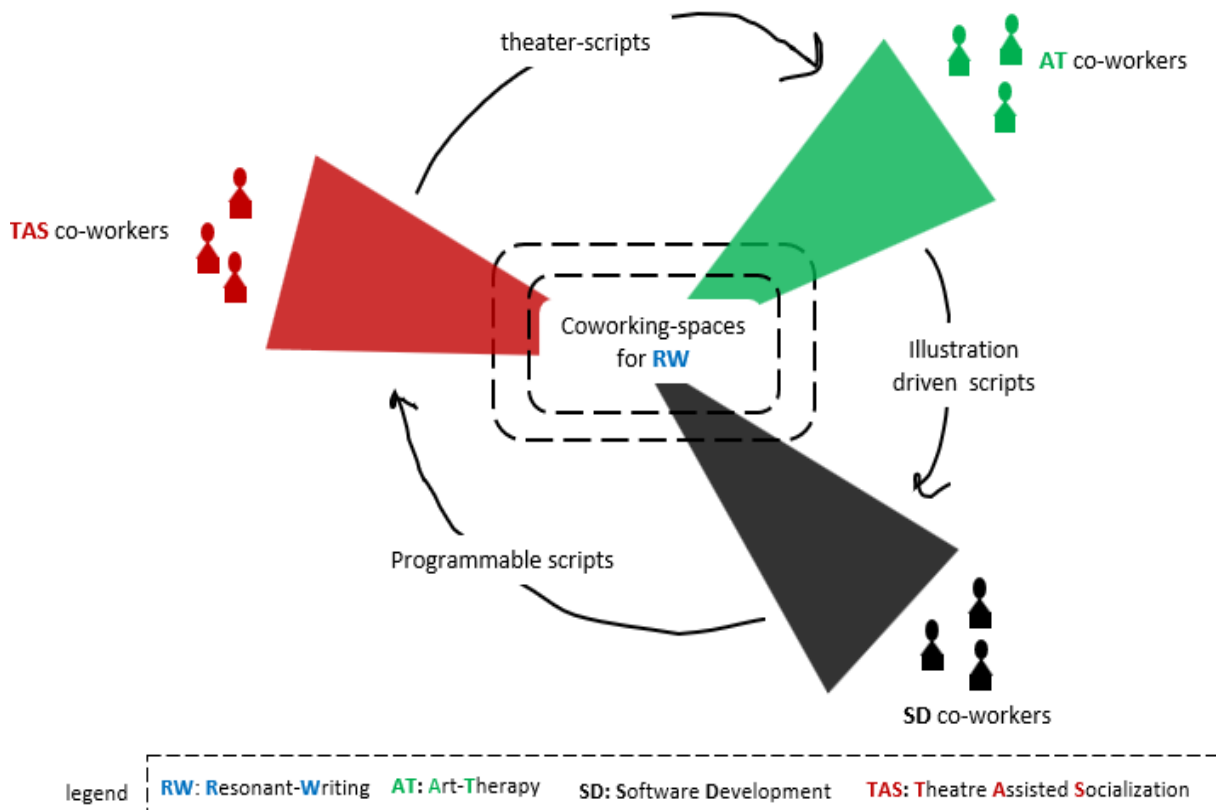


Fig 1. Workshops as coworking spaces for to research and experiment resonant-writing.

The draft writing scripts of the three co-workers should be reorganized and rewritten to produce a *RW* script that can be used for research or experimental goals.

The research challenges are defined based on the assumption that a *RW* script can consist at least of one or more of the sub-scripts presented in Fig. 1. The sub-scripts are illustration driven scripts, programmable scripts and theatre scripts. The challenges are presented in next section

3 PROJECT RESEARCH CHALLENGES

The research challenges can be formulated in question expression as it follows:

- 1 What are good "*RW* scripts" to serve social and nursing care for women in cancer?
 - o If women are migrants, how the writers of the *RW* scripts can understand their pre-migration cultures and their aesthetic values?

2 How “aesthetic-assessment methods” can be designed to capture the good-quality of producing “RW scripts”

To approach the challenges, the paper suggests an innovative design-approach towards inquiry based RW aesthetic-assessment. The approach is introduced in next section.

4 DESIGN APPROACH: INQUIRY BASED RW AESTHETIC-ASSESSMENT

Fig. 2 shows in big picture the design-approach towards inquiry based RW aesthetic-assessment.

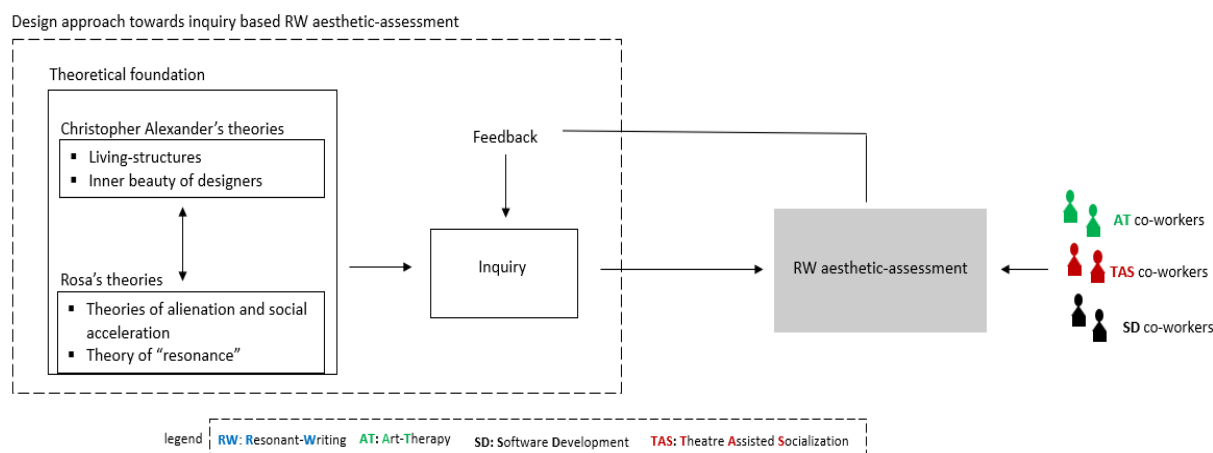


Fig 2. Design-approach towards inquiry based RW aesthetic-assessment.

It shows how the design-approach is conceptualized to enable researching how to integrate the design theorist Christopher Alexander's views on "living-structures"¹ [1] & "inner beauty"² and the sociologist Hartmut Rosa's theory of "resonance"³ [2] to approach alienation [3] phenomena in social-spaces

The figure also shows how the suggested design-approach can help the co-workers for AT , SD , TAS experiment inquiry based RW aesthetic-assessment.

Finally, the SD co-workers have suggested to look at aesthetic-assessments in a digital culture as form of **Formative eAssessment (FA)** activities.

To understand the FA state-of-research and state-of-practice our works in [4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10, 11] might be useful to the AT , SD & TAS co-workers.

In scope of this work-on-progress paper, there are initial inquiries conducted by the AT co-workers. The initial inquiries are about how to design an illustration driven script (see Fig . 1) for a Syrian migrant woman. The script should be designed as 5 minutes film format that helps this woman tell her life-experiences and cancer-experiences as aesthetic-Illustration driven story. This aesthetic-Illustration driven story is planned to be presented in our future works. In this work-on-progress paper, we can present few aesthetic-illustrations of this story. The illustrations and their short explanations are presented in Figs 3,4 and 5.

¹ In IEEE archive a full transcript of the talk "the Origins of Pattern Theory, the Future of the Theory, And the Generation of a Living World" by Christopher Alexander is available via <https://www.patternlanguage.com/archive/ieee.html> , last retrieved (18.09.2025)

² On September 5, 2011, Mr. Hiro Nakano, architect, interviewed Prof. Christopher Alexander, architect, at his home, Arundel, England. Prof. C. Alexander said that many places are feeling a kind of "Despaired," so the question is what to do about it. <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jpXNIOxupmM>., last retrieved (18.09.2025)

³ In German language a podcast about Rosa's theory of "resonance" is available via <https://soziopod.de/2020/04/soziopod-055-hartmut-rosa-resonanz/> , last retrieved (18.09.2025)



Fig 3. To help the Syrian woman after many operations to prevent the cancer development, this illustration was produced by an artist friend of the woman family. The illustration was produced as AI voluntary work.

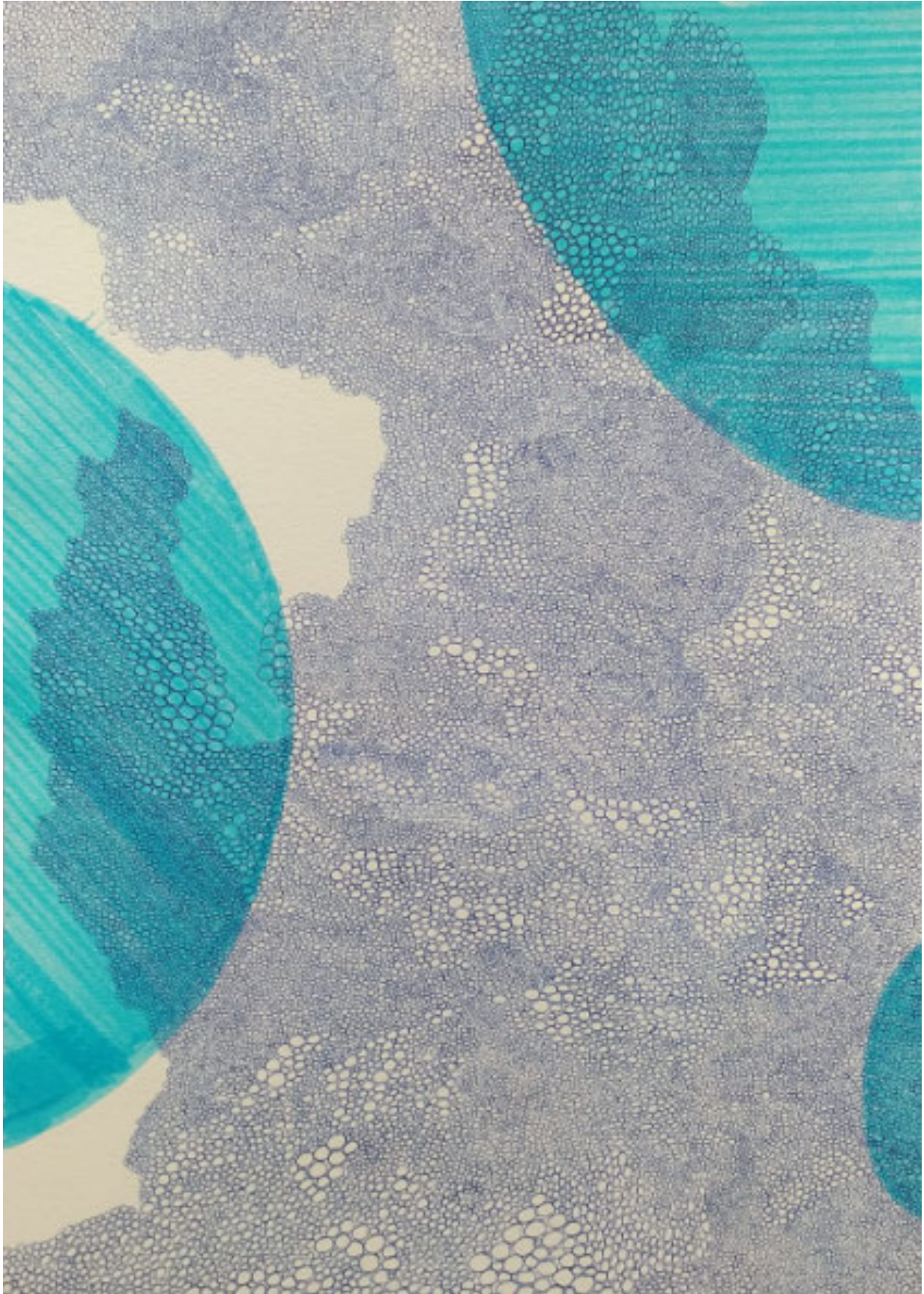


Fig 4. To help the Syrian woman in cancer reduce feeling of alienation, this illustration was produced by an artist friend of the woman family. The illustration was produced as AT voluntary work

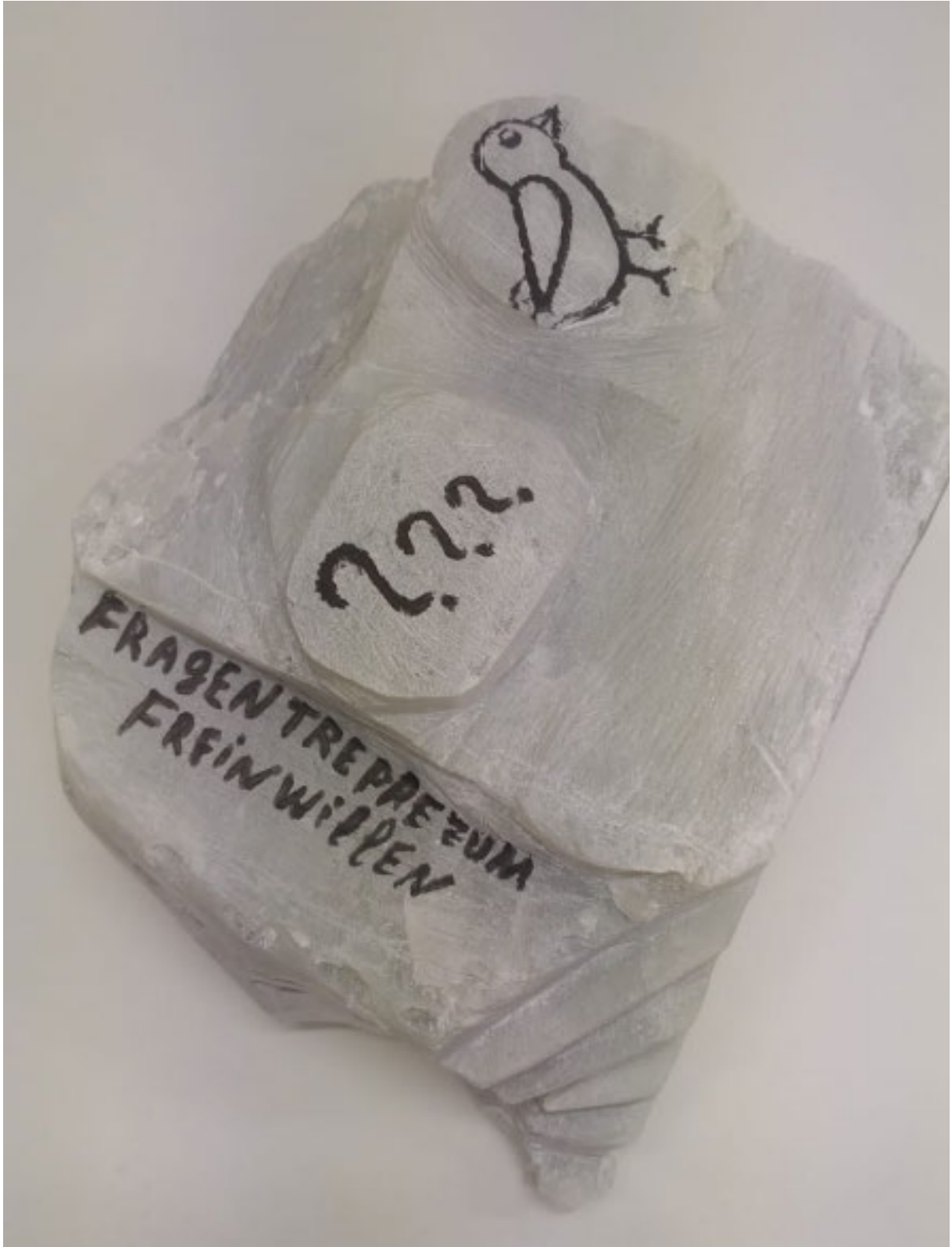


Fig 5. To help the Syrian woman in cancer tell her story in aesthetic way, an aesthetic workshop was organized with her. As outcome of this workshop, she was able with one of her family members to produce this stone sculpture. The sculpture has a stone stair, and a statement in German language “**Fragentreppe zum Freien Willen**”. In English it means “**Question ladder for free will**”.

5 CONCLUSIONS

This paper reports about the challenges of volunteer *AT*, *SD* and *TAS* co-workers in a design-project for supporting German and migrant-women in cancer (sections 2 and 3). The project helps volunteer co-workers reflect on how to understand and approach the alienation phenomena experienced and reported by women in cancer.

To approach the challenges, the paper suggests an innovative design-approach towards inquiry based *RW* aesthetic-assessment (section 4). The design-approach is conceptualized to enable researching how to integrate the design theorist Christopher Alexander's views on "living-structures" [1] and the sociologist Hartmut Rosa's theory of "resonance" [2] to approach alienation [3] phenomena in social-spaces.

The paper showed initial illustrations (Figs 3,4, and 5) for designing illustration driven script of 5 minutes film as *AT* voluntary work. The *AT* voluntary work is to help Syrian woman in cancer tell her story in an aesthetic way. Finally, for experimenting aesthetic ways of writing and acting *TAS* scripts, how to integrate Augusto Boal⁴'s works "aesthetics of the oppressed" and "theatre of the oppressed" in our suggested design approach is one of our research future questions.

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Mrs. Brigitte web site is: <https://www.atelier-kunstundtherapie.de/>

ACRONYMS

SD: Software Development

FA: Formative e-Assessment

AT: Art-Therapy

TAS: Theatre Assisted Socialization

RW: Resonant-Writing

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⁴ Augusto Boal (16 March 1931 – 2 May 2009) was a Brazilian theatre practitioner, drama theorist, and political activist. He was the founder of Theatre of the Oppressed.

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